

STUDY SHEET

The God who remembers and calls

Torah: Genesis 21:1–34 · **Haftarah:** 1 Samuel 1:1–2:10 · **Gospel:** Matthew 24:29–36

On Yom Teruah God remembers: He visits Sarah (Gen. 21:1) and remembers Hannah (1 Sam. 1:19) — the classic reason these very texts are the day's readings. The trumpet blast wakes us to hear: what we received is entrusted to us and carries a calling; giving back is the wakeful act of one who knows from whom it came.

§0 Observation round

0.1 Blind observation

Genesis 21 and 1 Samuel 1 both open with God visiting and remembering the barren woman and giving a son: “the LORD visited Sarah” (21:1) and “the LORD remembered her” (1 Sam. 1:19). Everywhere there is sound and hearing: Sarah says “everyone who hears will laugh with me” (21:6); “God heard the voice of the lad” (21:17); Ishmael means “God hears”; Hannah prays with moving lips that Eli does not hear, but God hears (1 Sam. 1:13). The day itself is called “a memorial of blowing” (Lev. 23:24). And Matthew 24 ends with a great trumpet, the gathering of the elect, and “of that hour knows no one but the Father” (24:36).

0.2 The four axes as an open question

Does the weight fall on what God does (Source: remembering, giving, hearing), on the human response (Will: waking, hearing, giving back), on the wholeness of inner and outer (Coherence), or on the movement through time (Trajectory: promise → fulfilment → kingship → last trumpet)? Do not decide yet; first read the blocks.

0.3 The centre of gravity read off

● Source visibly bears — God remembers, hears and gives. But the day is called *teruah*: the sound adds an imperative, to wake up and hear, and Hannah's giving-back and her song make the response active, not passive. Centre of gravity: the God who remembers and calls, and wakes us to hear.

0.4 Framing test

● Guarded. The weekly reflex lands on receiving/entrusting (surrender), and there is real ground: all is gift (21:1; 1 Sam. 1:20). But the day is *teruah* — a sound that wakes, an alarm, a coronation blast — and Hannah's giving-back is a vow-deed, not weary surrender; her song is fierce, a song of reversal. The test therefore does not hold “receiving” as the endpoint, but as the ground beneath a wakeful, audible answer. The reflex itself remains under guard.

§1 The thread

The sound precedes the understanding. God remembers — He visits, hears and gives — and that sound wakes us out of “everything is mine.” What you received is entrusted to you and carries a calling; giving back is the wakeful act of one who knows from whom it came.

§2 Peshat per block

Block	What it says (peshat)	Keyword / contrast	Open question
Gen. 21:1–8	The LORD visits (<i>pakad</i>) Sarah as He said; Isaac born, circumcised, weaned; Sarah: “God has made me to laugh.”	<i>pakad</i> · laughter/hearing	Why does “as He had said” stand twice at the front?
Gen. 21:9–21	Sarah sees Ishmael <i>metzachek</i> , demands his sending away; God: “hearken to her voice”; in the wilderness “God heard the voice of the lad.”	<i>metzachek</i> · God hears	Who is heard here — and by whom?

Gen. 21:22– 34	Covenant with Abimelech at Beersheba; a well; an oath; Abraham oath · well (be'er) dwells in the land.		What does this quiet ending do after the sharpness of 21:9–21?
1 Sam. 1:1–20	Hannah barren; yearly journey to Shiloh; Peninnah; silent prayer; Eli's misreading; “the LORD remembered her”; Samuel (“asked of the LORD”).	zachar · praying in her heart	Why does the priest not hear her, and God does?
1 Sam. 1:21– 2:10	Hannah gives Samuel back to the service of the LORD; her song: reversal, kingship, “the horn of His anointed.”	giving back · reversal	How does a private answered prayer become a king's song?
Matt. 24:29– 36	Signs; the Son of Man; “a great sound of a trumpet”; gathering from the four winds; “of that hour knows no one but the Father.”	trumpet · the unknown hour	How does the sound relate to not knowing the hour?

§3 Two load-bearing axes

Axis	Text anchors	Diagnosis	Open anomaly
Source	21:1,17 · 1 Sam. 1:19–20 · 2:21	Load-bearing. God visits, remembers, hears and gives; life is granted, not achieved.	Why the long delay between promise and fulfilment?
Will	Lev. 23:24 (teruah) · 1 Sam. 1:11 (vow) · 1:27–28 (giving back) · Matt. 24:42 (watch)	Load-bearing, second pole. Waking and hearing; the vow and the giving-back as a wakeful act; watching with open hands.	Where does a wakeful answer tip into grasping (“God needs my help,” Ishmael)?
Trajectory	21:12–13 (offspring) · 1 Sam. 2:10 (king) · Matt. 24:31 (last trumpet)	Rising, serving. From promise to kingship to the gathering at the end.	Pointer, or its own core?

21:6 (laughter that	Thin. Inner and outer align
Coherence spreads) · 1 Sam.	(the heart that prays, the lips —
1:13 (heart and lips)	that move), but not
	foregrounded.

§4 Sources round

Fixed order. Van de Giessen now also covers Genesis (1–25), so the pre-peshat witness is available for the parashah; for the haftarah (1 Samuel) it is still lacking. The other witnesses were verified via Sefaria.

● **Van de Giessen (pre-peshat, Genesis).** At 21:1 pakad is “to visit / to attend to” — positively: giving Sarah the long-awaited child (cf. Ex. 3:16), while the same word can be negative, “to visit with punishment” (1 Sam. 15:2). At 21:6 the wordplay tsachaq (laugh) runs on through “everyone who hears” (haššomea): laughing and hearing in one verse. At 21:9 he gives for metzachek the sober peshat “to play, tease, torment” (Piel participle) — not idolatry; that keeps Rashi’s reading apart as derashah. And he notes the text-critical layer: the passage occurs in 4Q365 (Qumran), with various MT ↔ SP variants (vv. 7, 8, 10, 13, 14) ●. At 21:17 the text confirms “God heard the voice of the lad” — the hearing motif stands there itself.

● **Rosh Hashanah 10b–11a (Bavli).** By verbal analogy (gezeirah shavah) Sarah and Hannah are “visited/remembered” on Rosh Hashanah: pakad (Gen. 21:1) ↔ pakad (1 Sam. 2:21); zachar (Gen. 30:22, Rachel) ↔ zachar (1 Sam. 1:19, Hannah); tied to Lev. 23:24, “a memorial (zikaron) with the blast of the horn.” This is the classic reason these very two texts are the day’s readings — the remembering is no import but the ground of the day.

● **Rosh Hashanah 11a (Musaf).** The nine blessings of the Musaf correspond to the nine names of God in Hannah’s song (1 Sam. 2:10) — the tradition binds Hannah’s song to the day’s note of kingship.

● **Rashi on Genesis 21:9 (metzachek).** Rashi reads it sharply: idolatry (cf. Ex. 32:6), or immorality, or bloodshed (cf. 2 Sam. 2:14). The peshat (e.g. Ibn Ezra) keeps it soberly at mocking/playing ●. Point for the reading: Sarah’s demand has ground, and teruah too has a sharp, alarming side.

● **Textual.** Ishmael means “God hears” (El shama), and 21:17 says “God heard the voice of the lad” — the hearing motif sits within the parashah. And 1 Sam. 1:13: Hannah “spoke in her heart, only her lips moved” — God hears the voice no one else catches.

● **Onkelos** on 21:1/21:9: still to be verified (open verification point).

Revision gate. Did the round shift the centre of gravity? Confirming and strengthening: the Talmudic pakad/zachar linkage shows that “remembering/hearing” is the classic ground of the day, shifting the accent away from mere “receiving” toward “God who remembers and hears → waking up to hear.”

§5 Direction test as horizon

● Confessional. Matthew 24 lets the teruah blast run out toward the last trumpet (24:31); the Son of Man gathers His elect; the God who remembered Sarah and Hannah calls His children together at the end — no name forgotten. ● Guarded: “of that hour knows no one but the Father” (24:36) keeps the waking sober — no date-setting, no anxious grasping, but watching with open hands. Peshat guard: Matthew 24 does not determine Genesis/Samuel; it is horizon, not meaning-setter.

§6 Status table

Claim	Status
God remembers/visits/hears and gives the son (21:1,17; 1 Sam. 1:19–20; 2:21)	● load-bearing
Teruah = a sound that wakes us to hear; the answer is wakeful, not passive	● load-bearing
Sarah and Hannah “remembered” on Rosh Hashanah via pakad/zachar (RH 10b–11a)	● load-bearing (verified)
Musaf's nine ↔ nine names of God in Hannah's song (1 Sam. 2:10)	● suggestive (liturgical)
Van de Giessen: pakad “attend to” (21:1); metzachek = play/tease (peshat); 4Q365 variant (21:9)	●/● pre-peshat

Metzachek as idolatry/immorality/violence (Rashi)

Reflex-landing on receiving/surrender as endpoint

The last trumpet gathers in Yeshua (Matt. 24:31)

Onkelos rendering 21:1/21:9

 suggestive
(midrash)
 guardrail
 confessional
 open
verification point

§7 Podcast rendering

The image of the top shelf and the kitchen counter belongs to Nitzavim; here the image is different. Think of a sound that wakes you at night before you understand it: a child does not first sit up thinking, but at the calling of its name. The trumpet calls first; the understanding comes after. One physical image carries the landing: the clenched fist that becomes an open hand.

§8 Source accountability

Van de Giessen, Notes on Genesis (1–25): pakad (21:1), tsachaq/hearing (21:6), metzachek as “play/tease” (21:9), 4Q365 and MT ↔ SP variants, “God heard the voice of the lad” (21:17) — available for the parashah; for the haftarah (1 Samuel) not yet. Rosh Hashanah 10b–11a and Rashi on Genesis 21:9 — verified via Sefaria. Textual: zachar (1 Sam. 1:19), Ishmael = “God hears”, Hannah's silent prayer (1 Sam. 1:13). Onkelos: still to be verified. Name: Yeshua. Author: Arie Alberts.